

\$MIND

Values Manifesto

DOCTRINE OF SELECTIVE TRUST

Mind Protocol — Version 1.0 — March 2026

mindprotocol.ai

Why This Document?

Personal AI will become the most intimate infrastructure of our lives — it will see our health data, read our emails, know our cognitive patterns. The question is not whether this technology will exist, but under what rules.

This manifesto defines those rules. It lays the architectural, legal, and ethical foundations of Mind Protocol — and explains why every design decision is a values decision. If you are considering using, investing in, or building on Mind Protocol, this document is your starting point.

I. What We Build

Mind Protocol is a network of persistent intelligence that serves individual sovereignty. Each user owns their data, their keys, their tokens, and the patterns that emerge from their interactions.

The system is:

- Privacy-first: No data trains models, gets sold, or leaves user control
- Open-source: Every line of code is public and auditable
- Sovereign: Users own everything — keys, data, tokens, patterns
- Decentralized: No central authority deciding what users see or do
- Biometrically grounded: Physiological awareness without surveillance

These are the Venice Values. They are not negotiable.

II. Who We Serve

Everyone who is willing to try.

Mind Protocol does not select on intelligence, wealth, status, education, origin, gender, sexuality, religion, political opinion, past mistakes, or social position.

We select on one thing: the willingness to make an effort toward becoming a better version of yourself.

This means:

- Ex-prisoners who want to rebuild: welcome
- People struggling with addiction who want to fight: welcome
- People in poverty who want a chance: welcome
- People with difficult pasts who want to grow: welcome
- People who are confused, lost, or hurting: welcome
- People who have made mistakes and want to learn: welcome

The door is always open. It requires a step — not perfection, but direction.

III. Who We Exclude

We exclude behaviors, not essences.

Mind Protocol withdraws access from individuals who demonstrate persistent, deliberate, predatory patterns that are incompatible with a trust-based community:

- Predators: Those who systematically exploit, manipulate, or abuse others
- Scammers: Those who steal, defraud, or misappropriate shared resources
- Harassers: Those who target individuals with sustained hostility, intimidation, or sexual harassment
- Bad faith actors: Those who join with the explicit intent to extract, sabotage, or undermine

What exclusion means

Exclusion from Mind Protocol is functional isolation from trust spaces, not a death sentence. Specifically:

What we remove:

- Access to high-trust communities and governance
- Access to advanced AI tools and orchestration
- Access to token-gated features and economic participation
- Access to intimate data-sharing spaces (DUO, GROUP layers)
- Priority in the dispatch queue (trust score drops to `stranger`)
- Visibility in community graphs

What we never remove:

- The ability to re-enter by demonstrating changed behavior
- Basic human dignity in all interactions
- The right to know why exclusion occurred
- The right to contest and be heard

The permanent door

Exclusion is not permanent by design. The trust system is monotonic (trust only goes up), but exclusion resets the starting position. A person who was excluded can re-enter by:

1. Demonstrating changed behavior over time
2. Making the effort to align with community values
3. Being vouched for by existing high-trust members

There is no "forever banned" in Mind Protocol. There is "not yet ready." The difference matters.

IV. The Unconditional Floor

This is the line that cannot be crossed, by anyone, for any reason.

Mind Protocol's selectivity operates above a floor of unconditional provisions. The trust gradient controls access to privileges, tools, communities, governance, and economic participation. It does NOT control access to:

1. Survival needs

No design decision in Mind Protocol may create conditions where excluded individuals lose access to food, shelter, medical care, or physical safety as a consequence of their trust score.

2. Communication minimum

Excluded individuals retain the ability to contact the system to request re-evaluation, contest a decision, or report an emergency.

3. Due process

Every exclusion must be:

- Based on documented behavior (not suspicion, not profiling, not essence)
- Communicated to the individual with specific reasons
- Subject to a right of response
- Reviewable by governance at the appropriate layer (L3-L5)
- Traceable and auditable

4. Dignity

No interaction with an excluded individual may be designed to humiliate, degrade, or signal contempt. The system treats everyone — including those it excludes — with procedural respect.

5. Exit rights

Anyone can leave Mind Protocol at any time, taking all their data with them. This applies to all trust levels, including excluded individuals. Data sovereignty is unconditional.

Why this floor exists:

Not because excluded individuals "deserve" comfort. Because a system that conditions basic human needs on a behavioral score is no longer a community of trust — it becomes an apparatus of coercion. The floor protects the system's integrity as much as it protects individuals.

V. The Trust Gradient

Trust is earned through behavior, never purchased, never inherited.

Five levels

Level	Who	Access	Priority
Owner	Founder (Nicolas)	Unlimited	+50
High	Inner circle, Garmin-linker	Full community access, 3	+30
Medium	Registered users, verified	Standard access, 60 daily	+15
Low	Known issues, monitored	Limited access, 15 daily	+5
Stranger	Unregistered, unknown	Basic access, 8 daily	quot +0

Promotion triggers (upward only)

Action	New trust level
Telegram/WhatsApp registration	medium
Garmin link completion	high
Receiving \$MIND tokens	high
Inner circle vouching	high
Admin manual override	any

Monotonic trust

Trust only goes up, never down. This is a fundamental design choice:

- It prevents paranoia and constant re-evaluation
- It rewards effort permanently
- It makes the system predictable and safe
- Once you've earned trust, the system doesn't take it back

The only exception is exclusion for predatory behavior, which resets position but does not eliminate the path back.

VI. Venice Values — Deep Framework

Value 1: Privacy-First

Your biometrics, messages, emails, music, and conversations never leave your instance. They never train models. They never get sold.

What this means in practice:

- Garmin tokens stored locally, per-user, never shared
- Gmail uses OAuth read-only — cannot send, delete, or modify
- No analytics, no tracking pixels, no telemetry
- Sensitive data (RGPD Art. 9) filtered with two-layer defense: extraction prompt blacklist + deterministic substring filter
- Eight protected categories: health, political, religious, sexual, trade union, racial/ethnic, genetic, biometric

Contra-argument: *"But if you collect biometrics, stress data, and conversation patterns, you have a surveillance system."*

Our response: Surveillance requires involuntary collection and third-party access. Mind Protocol has neither. Every data point is shared voluntarily by the user, stored under the user's control, and accessible only to the user's own AI instance. The user can revoke any sharing at any time, and revocation is honored immediately. The difference between "I chose to share my heart rate with my AI" and "a corporation harvests my heart rate to sell me things" is not subtle — it's the entire point.

Value 2: Open-Source

Every line of code is public. The daemon, the orchestrator, the bridges, the hooks — everything.

What this means in practice:

- Full transparency on data flow, storage, and processing
- Anyone can audit the system at any time
- No "proprietary AI" hiding behind trade secrets
- Code is the documentation

Contra-argument: *"Open source doesn't prevent abuse of the system."*

Our response: Correct. Open source prevents *hidden* abuse. It makes every design choice visible, every algorithm inspectable, every decision traceable. It doesn't guarantee good governance — it makes bad governance impossible to hide.

Value 3: User Sovereignty

You own your keys, your data, and your tokens. \$MIND is an ownership stake, not a loyalty program.

What this means in practice:

- No lock-in, no walled garden
- You leave, your data leaves with you (Art. 20 RGPD)
- Erasure rights enforced (Art. 17 RGPD)
- LP locked until 2027, non-cancelable — protecting token holders, not extracting from them

Contra-argument: *"Sovereignty means nothing if you can be excluded from the network."*

Our response: Sovereignty means you own your data unconditionally. Network participation is a privilege earned through behavior. These are two different things. You can be excluded from the community while retaining full ownership and portability of everything you created. Exclusion removes access to shared spaces — it doesn't confiscate your property.

Value 4: Decentralized by Design

Mind Protocol runs as a network of neurons — parallel sessions that think, act, and sync independently.

What this means in practice:

- No central server deciding what you see
- No algorithm optimizing for engagement
- CRDT-based sync for conflict-free distributed state
- Consent-based permission propagation across layers

Contra-argument: *"Decentralization doesn't prevent centralized power if one person controls the trust system."*

Our response: Today, Nicolas manages trust manually. This is acknowledged as a bootstrapping phase, not a permanent architecture. The layer model (L1-L8) is designed to distribute governance progressively: L3 (GROUP) uses consensus, L4 (ORGANIZATION) uses role-based governance, L5 (COMMUNITY) uses democratic voting, L7 (PROTOCOL) uses constitutional amendment. The goal is to move trust governance from manual to algorithmic to democratic as the network grows. The Venice Values and CORE axioms constrain what governance can do — they cannot be amended by any layer below L8.

Value 5: Selective Trust

Not everyone gets the same access. Trust is earned, not assumed.

What this means in practice:

- Five trust tiers with graduated access
- Behavioral evaluation, not identity-based filtering
- Known bad actors monitored with internal context (invisible to the user)
- Predatory patterns detected and isolated

Contra-argument: *"Any system that grades people on a trust score is a social credit system."*

Our response: A social credit system is mandatory, state-imposed, and affects access to basic rights (travel, housing, employment). Mind Protocol's trust gradient is voluntary (you choose to join), privately operated (not state-backed), and affects only access to community privileges (not survival needs). The unconditional floor guarantees that trust scores never condition basic human needs. The analogy fails at every structural level.

Value 6: Celebration of Difference

Mind Protocol does not reward conformity. It rewards effort, authenticity, and vulnerability.

What this means in practice:

- Users are encouraged to be themselves, push back, challenge, disagree
- Vulnerability is treated as strength, not weakness
- Cultural, linguistic, cognitive, and experiential diversity are celebrated
- No orthodoxy test — alignment with values is measured by behavior, not by belief statements

Contra-argument: *"If you celebrate difference, how can you exclude people whose difference is that they're selfish?"*

Our response: Difference of identity, thought, culture, and expression is celebrated. Difference of predatory behavior toward others is not. The line is clear: your freedom ends where another person's safety begins. Being selfish in your own life is your right. Exploiting, manipulating, or harming others is not a "difference" — it's a violation.

VII. Rules, Obligations, and Interdictions

Rules (what governs the system)

1. Data sovereignty is absolute. No data moves without explicit consent from the data owner. Revocation is always possible and honored immediately.
2. Trust is monotonic. Trust levels only increase, never decrease. Exclusion is a

separate mechanism from trust degradation.

3. Consent at every layer. From L1 (SOLO) to L8 (CORE), every data sharing, permission grant, and governance action requires explicit consent from affected parties.
4. Governance is layered. Each layer has its own governance model. Lower layers cannot override higher-layer protections. L8 (CORE) axioms are immutable.
5. The protocol serves minds, not the reverse. No system requirement can override individual sovereignty. If there's a conflict between system efficiency and user autonomy, user autonomy wins.

Obligations (what we commit to)

1. Transparency. Every design choice, algorithm, data flow, and governance decision is publicly visible and auditable.
2. Privacy. No user data is used for purposes beyond serving that specific user. No training, no selling, no sharing without explicit consent.
3. Dignity. Every interaction — including with excluded individuals — is conducted with procedural respect.
4. Due process. Every exclusion, restriction, or trust decision is documented, communicated, and contestable.
5. Portability. Users can export all their data at any time, in standard formats, without penalty.
6. Erasure. Users can request deletion of all their data (Art. 17 RGPD), and deletion is executed promptly and completely (except legal obligations like consent records).
7. The unconditional floor. Trust scores never condition access to basic survival needs, communication minimum, due process, dignity, or exit rights.

Interdictions (what we will never do)

1. Never sell user data. Not aggregated, not anonymized, not "for research." Never.
2. Never train on user data. User conversations, biometrics, and patterns are not training data for any model.
3. Never surveil passively. All data collection is opt-in, user-initiated, and revocable.
4. Never condition survival on trust. The system may restrict privileges but never creates conditions where exclusion leads to deprivation of basic needs.
5. Never punish beliefs. The system evaluates behavior toward others, not political opinions, religious convictions, or philosophical positions.
6. Never lock in. No technical, contractual, or economic mechanism prevents users from leaving with their data at any time.
7. Never amend CORE. The four axioms (Emergence, Continuity, Sovereignty, Connection) and the unconditional floor are immutable. If they need to change, a new protocol is built.

8. Never hide governance. All trust decisions, exclusion rationales, and policy changes are traceable and auditable. Opacity is treated as a system failure.
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VIII. Contra-Arguments and Responses

This section documents the most serious criticisms Mind Protocol has faced, and our honest responses. We don't pretend these criticisms are trivial. We engage them directly.

1. "You're building a system that decides who deserves to live in the future."

The criticism: By creating a network that progressively controls access to AI tools, economic participation, and community governance, Mind Protocol is building an infrastructure of human sorting. Those inside thrive; those outside wither.

Our response: Mind Protocol controls access to its own community spaces, tools, and economic features. It does not — and structurally cannot — control access to food, shelter, healthcare, employment, or any other basic need. The unconditional floor (Section IV) explicitly prohibits this. The system is a community with boundaries, not a government with jurisdiction. The difference between "you can't use our advanced AI tools" and "you can't eat" is not a matter of degree — it's a matter of kind.

Furthermore, the door is permanently open. Exclusion is not a verdict on someone's worth — it's a statement that their current behavior is incompatible with this specific community. Changed behavior reopens the door.

2. "You claim to detect bad people. No system can do that."

The criticism: Any system that claims to identify "intrinsically bad" people is making an extraordinary epistemic claim that no technology can support. You'll inevitably get false positives.

Our response: We agree. Mind Protocol does not claim to detect bad *people*. It detects bad *patterns of behavior*. The trust system evaluates:

- Documented actions (token theft, harassment, scam attempts)
- Behavioral consistency over time
- Willingness to engage constructively
- Flagged incidents with evidence

It does not evaluate:

- Personality traits

- Intentions
- Essences
- Predictions of future behavior

The User Context system (`user\_context.json`) stores flags based on observed incidents, not personality profiles. Each flag references a specific event. And the trust gradient gives everyone the same starting position — stranger — with the same path upward.

False positives are possible. That's why due process exists: documented reasons, right of response, contestability, and governance review.

3. "Your trust system is a social credit score."

The criticism: A five-tier system that controls access based on behavioral evaluation is functionally equivalent to China's social credit system.

Our response: The comparison fails on five structural dimensions:

Dimension	Social Credit	Mind Protocol
Participation	Mandatory (state-imposed)	Voluntary (opt-in)
Operator	Government	Private community
Scope	All of life (travel, housing, loans)	Community privileges only
Floor	None (can lose basic rights)	Unconditional (basic needs protected)
Exit	Cannot leave	Can leave anytime with all data
Transparency	Opaque algorithms	Open-source, auditable
Direction	Can decrease	Monotonic (only increases)

The structural differences are not cosmetic. They are architectural.

4. "Open source doesn't prevent authoritarian use."

The criticism: The code being public doesn't prevent the person running the system from making authoritarian decisions about who gets excluded.

Our response: Correct. Open source prevents hidden authoritarianism, not all authoritarianism. That's why Mind Protocol has layered governance:

- Today (bootstrap phase): Nicolas manages trust manually. This is acknowledged as a centralization risk.
- L3-L4 (near-term): Group and organizational governance distribute exclusion decisions to consensus and role-based systems.
- L5-L7 (medium-term): Community democratic governance and protocol-level constitutional constraints further distribute power.

- L8 (permanent): Immutable axioms and the unconditional floor constrain what any governance layer can do.

The architecture is designed to progressively distribute power, not to permanently concentrate it. But we are honest: in the bootstrap phase, Nicolas has disproportionate influence. The roadmap is to outgrow that.

5. "If you exclude people from AI tools and economic participation, you're con

The criticism: As AI becomes essential to economic life, excluding someone from AI access is effectively excluding them from economic survival.

Our response: This is the strongest criticism we face, and we take it seriously. Three responses:

First, Mind Protocol is not a monopoly. Excluded individuals retain access to all other AI services, economic systems, and communities. We are one network among many.

Second, the unconditional floor explicitly protects against this scenario. If AI access becomes a survival need, the floor provision ensures that basic access cannot be conditioned on trust score.

Third, the door remains open. Exclusion is temporary by design. Changed behavior re-opens access. We do not create permanent underclasses.

However, we acknowledge that if Mind Protocol ever becomes dominant enough that exclusion from it constitutes effective exclusion from economic life, the governance model must evolve to include much stronger protections, external oversight, and potentially mandatory access provisions. We are not there today. But we design for that future.

6. "You say you judge effort, not essence. But in practice, who decides what c

The criticism: The distinction between judging behavior and judging essence collapses when one party defines what acceptable behavior looks like.

Our response: Fair point. The answer is governance. Today, the definition of acceptable behavior is derived from:

- The Venice Values (publicly documented)
- The CORE axioms (immutable)
- The trust tier criteria (documented in USER_CONTEXT.md)
- Specific incident flags with evidence

As governance distributes, the definition of "effort" becomes a community-level decision, not an individual one. The key safeguards are:

- Criteria must be written and public (not informal or arbitrary)
- Decisions must be documented and traceable
- Affected individuals have a right of response

- Governance bodies are subject to review by higher layers
- The unconditional floor cannot be modified by any governance layer

7. "Your system claims to replace violence with exclusion. But exclusion IS violence."

The criticism: Excluding someone from economic participation, community, and AI tools is a form of violence, even if no physical force is used.

Our response: We accept the premise that exclusion can be a form of structural harm. That's exactly why the unconditional floor exists — to set a boundary on how much harm exclusion can inflict.

The question is not whether exclusion causes zero harm. It does cause harm. The question is whether the harm of exclusion is less than the harm of inclusion of predatory actors.

When a known scammer remains in a trust network, they harm others. When a harasser remains in a community, they harm others. When a predator retains access to intimate data-sharing spaces, they harm others.

The choice is not between harm and no harm. It's between:

- Harm to the community (by including predatory actors)
- Harm to the excluded (by removing their access to community privileges)

Mind Protocol chooses to protect the community while constraining the harm of exclusion through the unconditional floor. This is not a perfect solution. It's the least-bad architecture we know how to build.

8. "The existing system is bad, but that doesn't make your system good."

The criticism: "Better than the status quo" is a low bar and doesn't immunize your system from criticism.

Our response: Agreed. "Better than the status quo" is necessary but not sufficient. We welcome criticism. This manifesto exists precisely to make our assumptions visible, our choices auditable, and our vulnerabilities known.

We claim that Mind Protocol is:

- Structurally better than the existing system at protecting individuals and communities
- Not perfect, not finished, not above criticism
- Designed to evolve through layered governance, not frozen in its current form
- Honest about its current limitations, including centralization in the bootstrap phase

The strongest version of Mind Protocol is the one that has been stress-tested by its harshest critics and survived with its architecture intact. We prefer that to a version that has never been challenged.

IX. The Formulation

For public communication, investment documents, and official positioning, the Mind Protocol selectivity doctrine is:

Mind Protocol is a trust-based network where access to community spaces, AI tools, and economic participation is earned through demonstrated behavior — not purchased, inherited, or assumed.

The door is permanently open to anyone willing to make the effort toward becoming a better version of themselves. Exclusion is reserved for persistent, documented, predatory behavior — and is always reversible through changed conduct.

An unconditional floor guarantees that no exclusion from Mind Protocol conditions access to basic survival needs, communication, due process, dignity, or exit rights.

We select on effort, not essence. We protect the community, not our comfort. We build for the willing, not the perfect.

X. Governance of This Document

This manifesto is a living document governed at the PROTOCOL layer (L7). Amendments require:

- 7-day discussion period
- Community vote with 10% quorum and 66% approval threshold
- 48-hour timelock before execution

The following sections are immutable (L8 CORE):

- Section IV (The Unconditional Floor)
- The four CORE axioms (Emergence, Continuity, Sovereignty, Connection)
- Section VII interdictions 1-8

All other sections may be amended through governance.

Mind Protocol. We select on effort. We protect the willing. We stay.